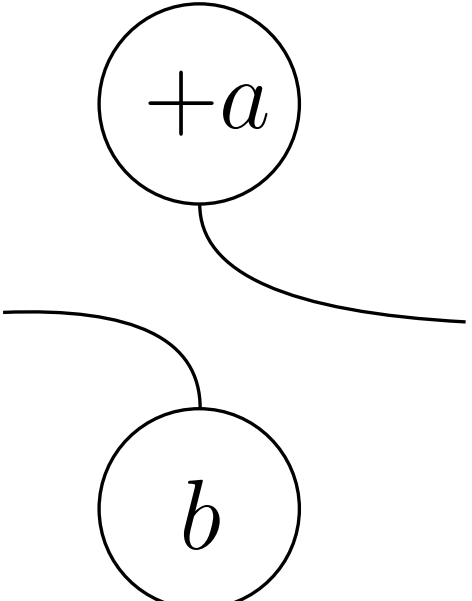

with $0 < b \leq a$